

SONG JOURNEY

"the cure"

Olivia Rodrigo

Thread song — it appears in all 5 modules

One song, five layers. Each module adds a new skill to this song. Layer 6 is a bonus.

Form	Verse → Chorus → Verse → Chorus → Outro
Verse chords	Am · C · F · C
Chorus chords	Dm · F · C · G/B
Rhythm	One chord per bar. 4 beats each. No capo.
Tempo	Practice at 60 BPM. The record feels like 72 BPM.

LAYER 1 Listen

Module 1

Listen to the song 3 times.

1. Listen for the guitar. It is acoustic and clean.
2. Listen for the chords changing.
3. Listen for how the song gets louder at the end.

Do it: Count the chord changes in one verse. How many different chords do you hear? _____**You've got it when:** You can hum the main hook from memory.**Level up**

Listen one more time. Find the moment the chorus starts.

What changes? _____

LAYER 2 Single Notes

Module 2

Play the root notes of the verse: A · C · F · C. All of them are on the low E string.

Verse root line · low E string · 4 beats per note

	A	C	A	C
e	-----	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----	-----
D	-----	-----	-----	-----
A	-----	-----	-----	-----
E	--5--5--5--5--	--8--8--8--8--	--5--5--5--5--	--8--8--8--8--

	F	C	F	C
e	-----	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----	-----
D	-----	-----	-----	-----
A	-----	-----	-----	-----
E	--1--1--1--1--	--8--8--8--8--	--1--1--1--1--	--8--8--8--8--

Play it: 4 beats per note at 60 BPM. Pick each note once per beat.

A = pinky, fret 5 · C = slide up, index on fret 8 · F = index, fret 1

Say each note name out loud.

You've got it when: 2 clean laps at 60 BPM. Your hand moves from fret 8 back to fret 1 without looking.

Level up

Play the same notes on the A string. F stays on the low E.

Level up · A and C on the A string · 4 beats per note

	A	C	F	C
e	-----	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----	-----
D	-----	-----	-----	-----
A	--0--0--0--0--	--3--3--3--3--	-----	--3--3--3--3--
E	-----	-----	--1--1--1--1--	-----

LAYER 3 Power Chords**Module 3**

Optional harder challenge. No score.

Play the whole song with one power chord shape. Play it quietly.

Verse: A5 · C5 · F5 · C5 Chorus: D5 · F5 · C5 · G5

Power chords · root on the low E · 4 beats per chord

	A5	C5	F5	C5
e	-----	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----	-----
D	-----	-----	-----	-----
A	--7--7--7--7--	--10 10 10 10--	--3--3--3--3--	--10 10 10 10--
E	--5--5--5--5--	--8--8--8--8--	--1--1--1--1--	--8--8--8--8--

	D5	F5	C5	G5
e	-----	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----	-----
D	-----	-----	-----	-----
A	--12 12 12 12--	--3--3--3--3--	--10 10 10 10--	--5--5--5--5--
E	--10 10 10 10--	--1--1--1--1--	--8--8--8--8--	--3--3--3--3--

Play it: 4 beats per chord at 60 BPM. One soft down-strum per beat.

Move both fingers together when you change chords.

You've got it when: 2 laps, clean and soft. Every change lands on beat 1.

Level up

Play the bassline as single notes. The last note is B, fret 7 — the bass note the record plays under G/B.

Then play one lap loud and one lap very soft.

Level up · bassline as single notes · 4 beats per note

	A	C	F	C
e	-----	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----	-----
D	-----	-----	-----	-----
A	-----	-----	-----	-----
E	--5--5--5--5--	--8--8--8--8--	--1--1--1--1--	--8--8--8--8--

	D	F	C	B
e	-----	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----	-----
D	-----	-----	-----	-----
A	-----	-----	-----	-----
E	--10 10 10 10--	--1--1--1--1--	--8--8--8--8--	--7--7--7--7--

LAYER 4 Pentatonic Solo**Module 4**

Solo with A minor pentatonic. Play softly. Leave space between notes.

Four rungs. Climb them in order.

Rung 1 · Rule of 3

Your three starting notes · A minor pentatonic, Pattern 1

	A	C	D
e	-----		
B	-----		
G	-----		
D	-----		
A	-----5-----		
E	--5-----8-----		

Play it: Put on the song. Improvise 8 bars with these 3 notes.

Start or end every phrase on A. A is the home note.

You've got it when: Your quietest note is as clean as your loudest.

Rung 2 · The whole box

The whole box · A minor pentatonic Pattern 1 · 5th fret

e	--5-----8-----
B	--5-----8-----
G	--5-----7-----
D	--5-----7-----
A	--5-----7-----
E	--5-----8-----

Play it: Play the box up and down, softly. Then improvise anywhere inside it.

Rung 3 · Hammer-ons and slides

h = hammer-on. Pick the first note, then tap the higher fret with your ring finger.

/ = slide. Pick once, keep pressing, slide up.

Hammer-ons and slides · all inside Pattern 1

	G A	C D	G A	A
e	-----			
B	-----			
G	-----5h7-----			
D	--5h7-----5/7-----7-----			
A	-----			
E	-----			

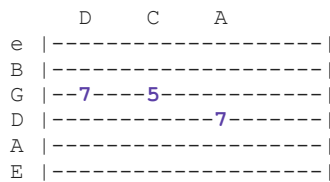
Play it: Practice each move slowly. The second note must sound clearly.

Then add them to your 3-note phrases.

Rung 4 · Two soft licks

Lick 1 · going up · ends on A, let it ring

	E	G	A
e	-----		
B	-----		
G	-----		
D	-----5-----7-----		
A	--7-----		
E	-----		

Lick 2 · going down · ends on A, let it ring

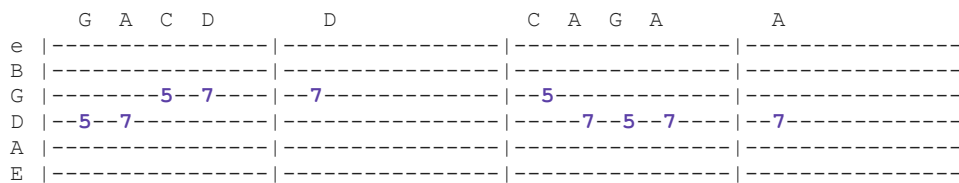
Play it: Learn each lick exactly. Then change one note or change the rhythm.

You've got it when: Your solo uses the box, one hammer-on or slide, and one lick.

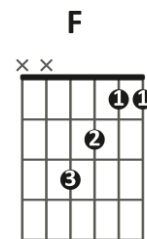
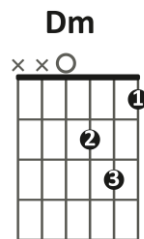
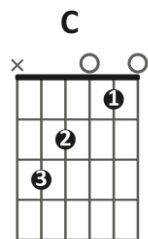
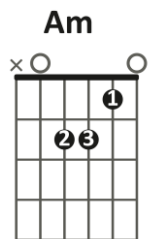
Level up

Call and response. Play 2 bars that end away from A. Then play 2 bars that end on A.

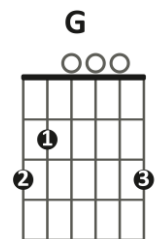
Here is one to start with. Then make your own.

Level up · call and response · 4 bars**LAYER 5 Open Chords****Module 5**

Play the whole song with open chords. One chord per bar. No capo.



little shape (xx3211)



G/B = this G shape, skip the low E string

Open chords · 4 beats per chord · 60 → 65 → 70 BPM

VERSE				CHORUS			
Am	C	F	C	Dm	F	C	G/B
1 2 3 4	1 2 3 4	1 2 3 4	1 2 3 4	1 2 3 4	1 2 3 4	1 2 3 4	1 2 3 4

Play it: Down-strums, one per beat. Start at 60 BPM. Then 65. Then 70.

G/B = the G shape without the low E string. The B note is now the bass.

You've got it when: 2 clean loops of the verse and 2 of the chorus at 70 BPM. Every change on beat 1.

Level up

Folk strum on every chord: D D U U D U.

Or play with a partner: you strum, your partner solos Layer 4 over you.

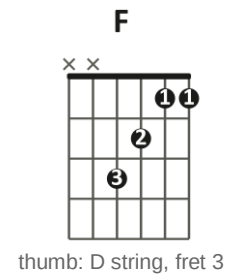
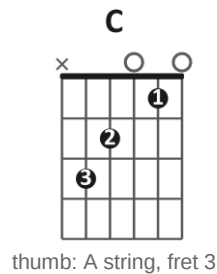
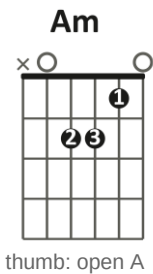
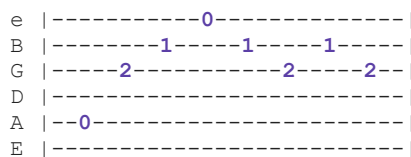
Level up · folk strum · one bar per chord

Am	C
1 2 & 3 & 4 &	1 2 & 3 & 4 &
D D U U D U	D D U U D U
F	C
1 2 & 3 & 4 &	1 2 & 3 & 4 &
D D U U D U	D D U U D U

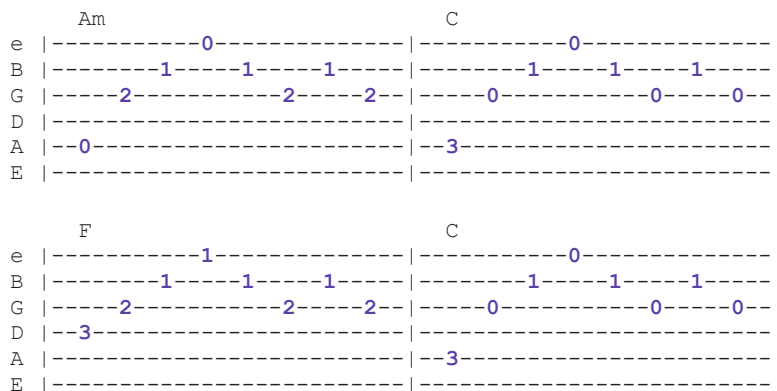
LAYER 6 Fingerpicked Verse**Bonus***Bonus layer. Optional harder challenge. No score.*

No strumming. Pick 8 notes per bar: p i m a m i m i. Two notes per beat.

p = thumb · i = index · m = middle · a = ring. The thumb plays the bass note. The fingers stay on the G, B, and e strings.

**Am · p i m a m i m i · one bar**

Play it: One bar of Am at 60 BPM. p = open A · i = G string · m = B string · a = high e string. Then play the whole verse. Only the thumb changes strings.

The verse · one bar per chord · 60 BPM

You've got it when: The verse loop Am · C · F · C runs at 60 BPM without stopping.

Level up

Play the chorus the same way: Dm · F · C · G/B.

Thumb: Dm = open D · F = D string, fret 3 · C = A string, fret 3 · G/B = A string, fret 2.

Level up · the chorus · one bar per chord

Dm

F

e

B

G

D

A

E

1

3

2

0

1

3

2

3

C

G/B

e

B

G

D

A

E

0

1

0

3

1

1

0

0

1

0

0

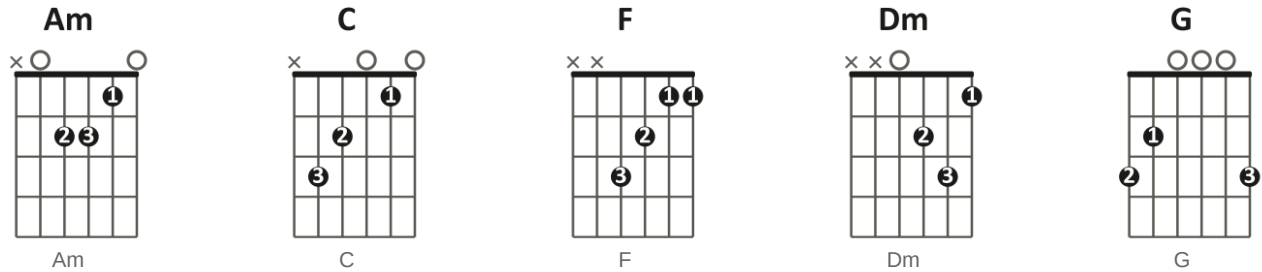
2

FULL CHORD CHART

"the cure"

Olivia Rodrigo

Key A minor · no capo (capo 1 to match the record)
Tempo Practice at 60 BPM · the record feels like 72 · 4/4
Rhythm One chord per bar · 4 beats each
Form Verse → Chorus → Verse → Chorus → Outro

Shapes you need**VERSE**

	Am		C		F		C	
--	-----------	--	----------	--	----------	--	----------	--

Soft. Repeat until the chorus.

CHORUS

	Dm		F		C		G/B	
--	-----------	--	----------	--	----------	--	------------	--

Fuller strumming. G/B = G chord with the B note in the bass.

VERSE

	Am		C		F		C	
--	-----------	--	----------	--	----------	--	----------	--

Same as the first verse.

CHORUS

	Dm		F		C		G/B	
--	-----------	--	----------	--	----------	--	------------	--

Same as the first chorus.

OUTRO

The ending. Listen to the record and follow it.

Teaching chart — simplified to match the Journey layers. Chord names are what the class plays in standard tuning.

The Cure Chords by Olivia Rodrigo



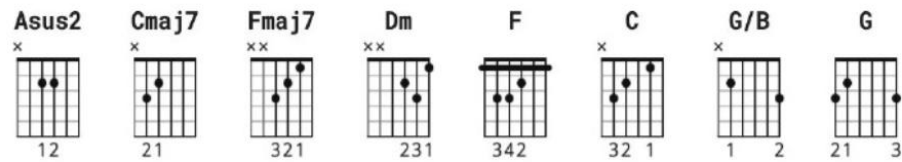
Difficulty: beginner

Tuning: E A D G B E

Capo: 1st fret

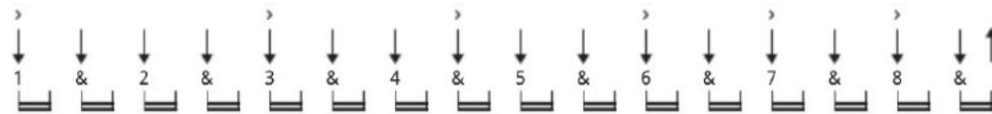
Key: Db

CHORDS



STRUMMING PATTERN

MAIN PATTERN 144 bpm



[Intro]

Asus2 Cmaj7

Asus2 Cmaj7

[Verse 1]

Asus2 Cmaj7

All the pretty girls in the foreground of my mind

Asus2 Cmaj7

I thought I'd done enough, but they keep moving the line

Fmaj7 Cmaj7

I thought I'd found the antidote this time

Fmaj7 Cmaj7

I thought I'd found the antidote this time

[Verse 2]

Asus2 Cmaj7

All the nights I spent fighting bad thoughts in my room

Asus2 Cmaj7

Feeling so alone, might as well be on the moon

Fmaj7 Cmaj7

I thought I'd found the antidote with you

Fmaj7 Cmaj7

I thought I'd found the antidote with you

[Chorus]

Dm **F**
But my head is full of poison, and my heart is full of doubt
C **G/B**
I got toxins in my bloodstream, you tried hard to suck 'em out
Dm **F**
And it feels like medication, and it's good for me, I'm sure
C **G/B**
But it don't matter how your love feels anymore
Dm **F**
It'll never be the cure
C **G/B**
It'll never be the cure

[Verse 3]

Asus2 **Cmaj7**
I used to play a game in my head when I'd date a guy
Asus2 **Cmaj7**
Tally up the girls that he fucked 'til I start to cry
Fmaj7 **Cmaj7**
I thought I'd found the antidote this time
Fmaj7 **Cmaj7**
I thought I'd found the antidote this time

[Refrain]

F
But I'm unraveled (I'm unraveled)
C **G**
I'm unraveled (I'm unraveled)
F
I'm unraveled (I'm unraveled)
C **G**
I'm unraveled (I'm unraveled)

[Chorus]

Dm **F**
And my head is full of poison, and my heart is full of doubt
C **G/B**
I got toxins in my bloodstream, you tried hard to suck 'em out
Dm **F**
And it feels like medication, and it's good for me, I'm sure
C **G/B**
But it don't matter how your love feels anymore
Dm **F**
It'll never be the cure
C **G/B**
It'll never be the cure, oh

[Refrain]

F
'Cause, baby, I'm unraveled (I'm unraveled)
C **G**
I'm unraveled (I'm unraveled)
F
I'm unraveled (I'm unraveled)
C **G** **F**
I'm unraveled (I'm unraveled, I'm unraveled)

[Bridge]

C
Why can't you come stitch me up? (I'm unraveled)
G **F**
Why can't it ever be enough? (I'm unraveled)
C
Why can't you come stitch me up? (I'm unraveled)
G **Dm**
Why can't it ever be enough?
F
Ooh-oh
C **G/B**
It's not enough

[Chorus]

Dm **F**
All because my head is full of poison, and my heart is full of doubt (I'm unraveled)
C **G/B**
I got toxins in my bloodstream, you tried so hard to suck out (I'm unraveled)
Dm **F**
And it feels like medication, and it's good for me, I'm sure (I'm unraveled)
C **G/B**
But it don't matter how your love feels anymore (I'm unraveled)
Dm **F**
It'll never be the cure
C **G/B**
It will never be the cure

It'll never be

[Outro]

Dm F C G/B
Dm F C G/B